

State of the Web 2020–2025

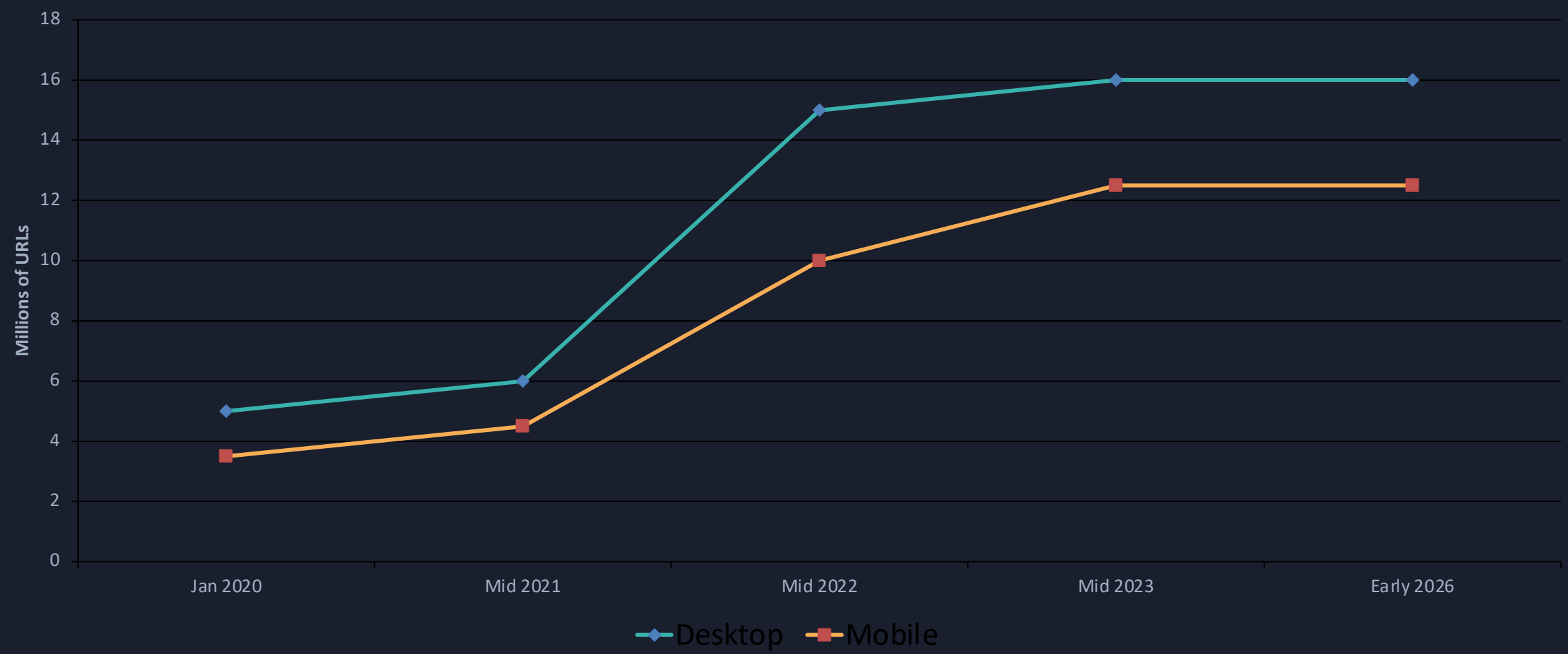
HTTP Archive Trends in Page Weight, Protocols, and Security

Data Source: HTTP Archive — State of the Web Report | Jan 2020 – Mar 2026

Audience: Web Performance Engineers & Front-End Architects

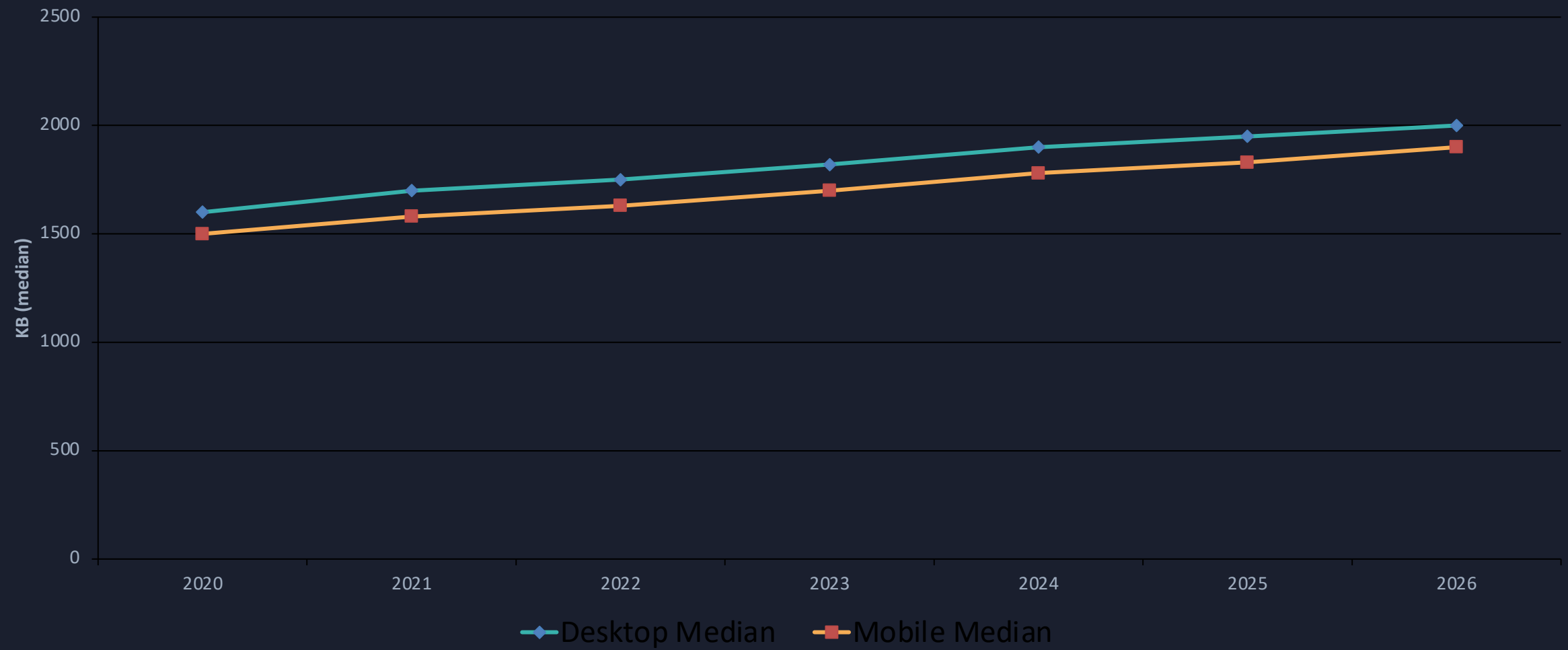
Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020

HTTP Archive continuously crawls millions of URLs. The sample jumped sharply in mid-2022 and has stabilized near 16M desktop / 12.5M mobile.



Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop

Desktop median transfer size rose ~25% from ~1,600 KB (2020) to ~2,000 KB. Mobile tracks slightly lower. 75th-percentile desktop pages exceed 4,000 KB.



76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

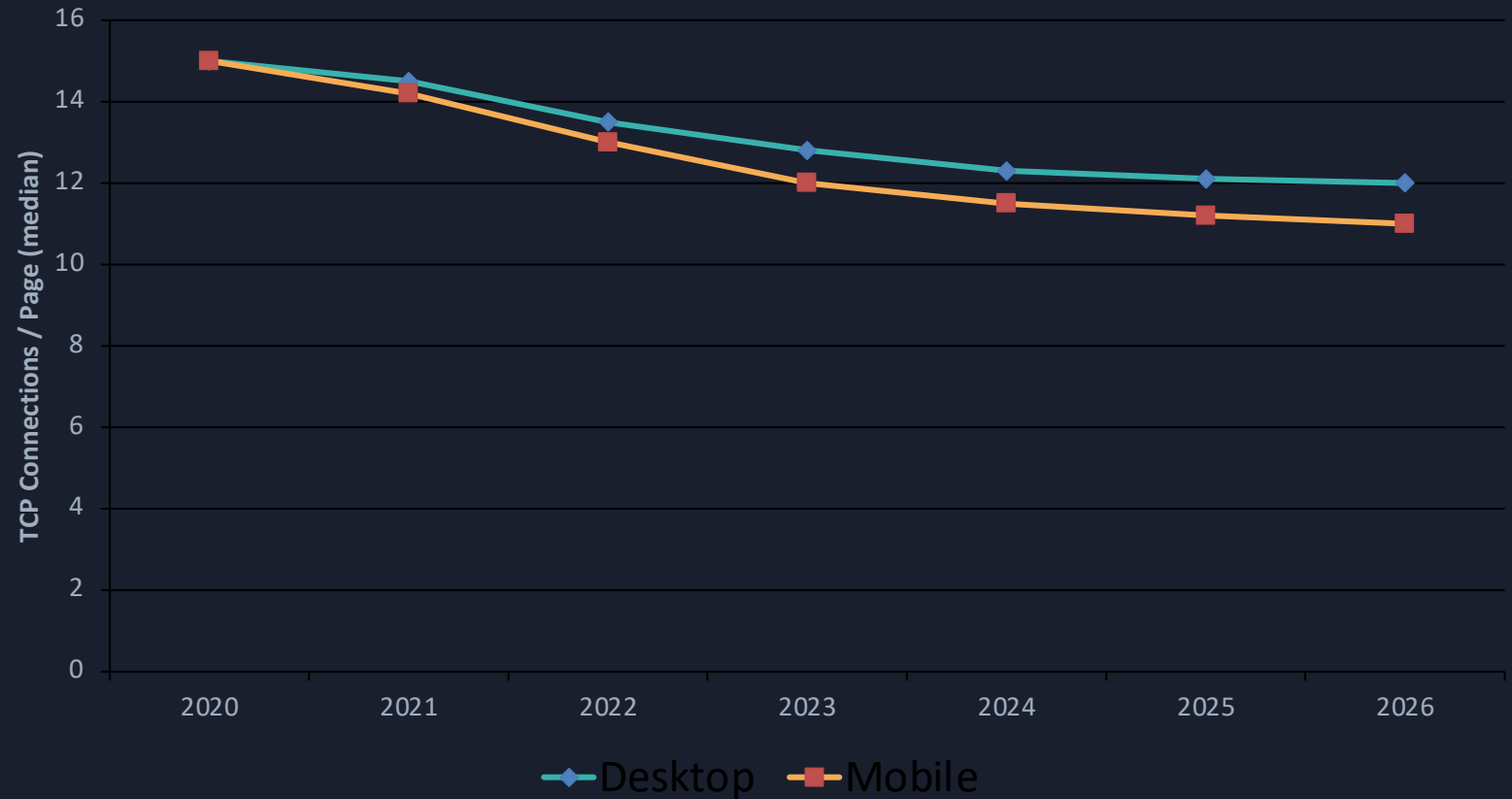
Request counts rose ~3%, yet TCP connections fell 14–27% thanks to HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 multiplexing.

76

Desktop Requests (median)

71

Mobile Requests (median)



HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

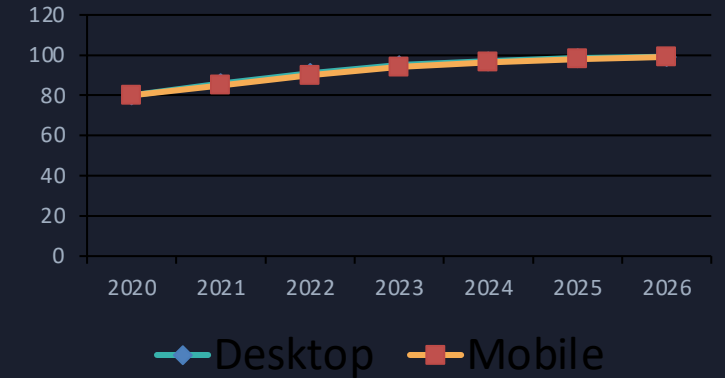
Unencrypted HTTP is effectively extinct. Adoption climbed ~19–20 percentage points from ~80% in early 2020.

99.2%

Desktop HTTPS Requests

99.1%

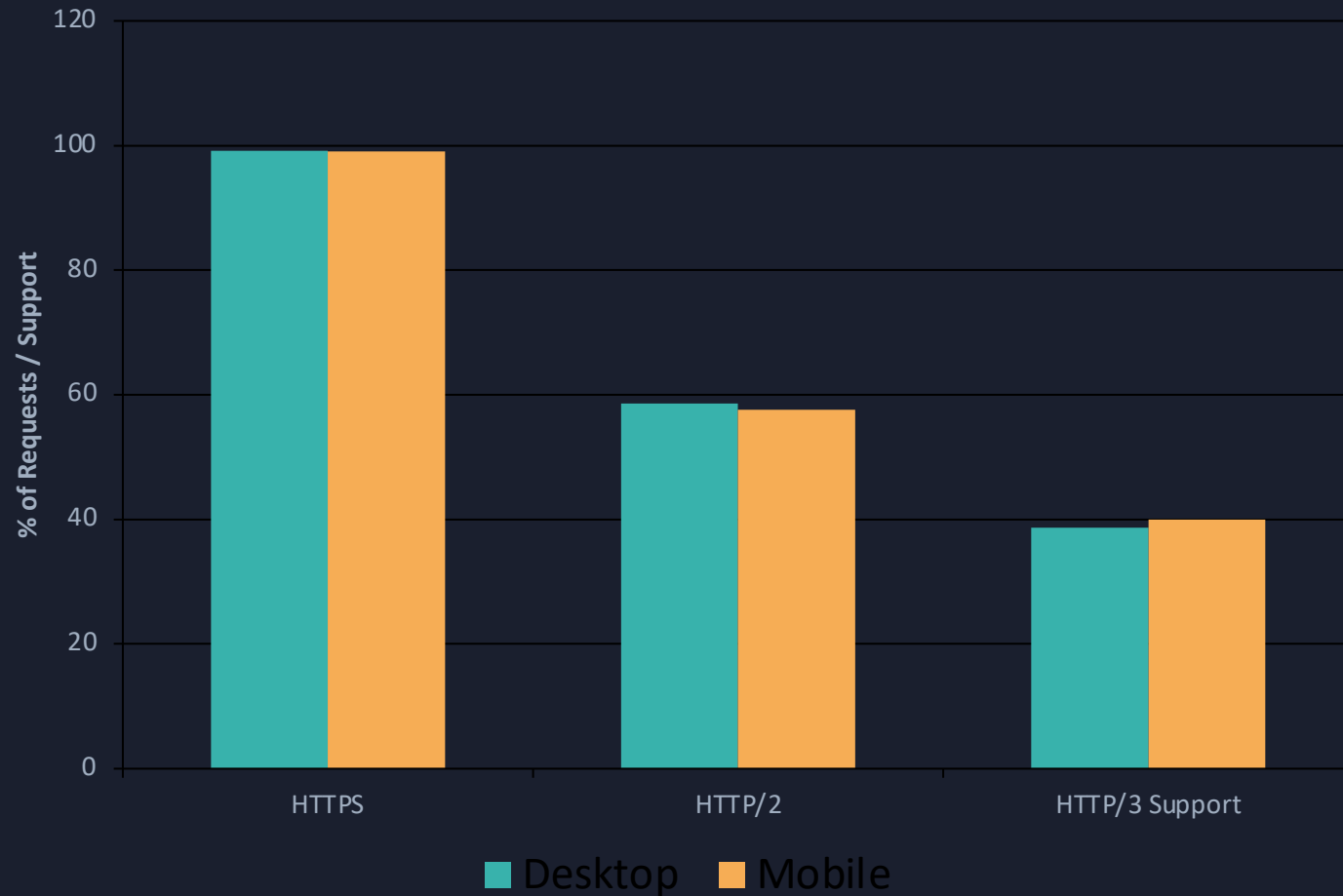
Mobile HTTPS Requests



2020 Baseline: ~80% → 2026: 99.2% desktop / 99.1% mobile (+19–20 pp)

HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

HTTP/2 growth has flattened as HTTP/3 absorbs newer adoption. HTTP/3 support measured via fresh Chrome Alt-Svc discovery.



38.7%

Desktop HTTP/3 Support

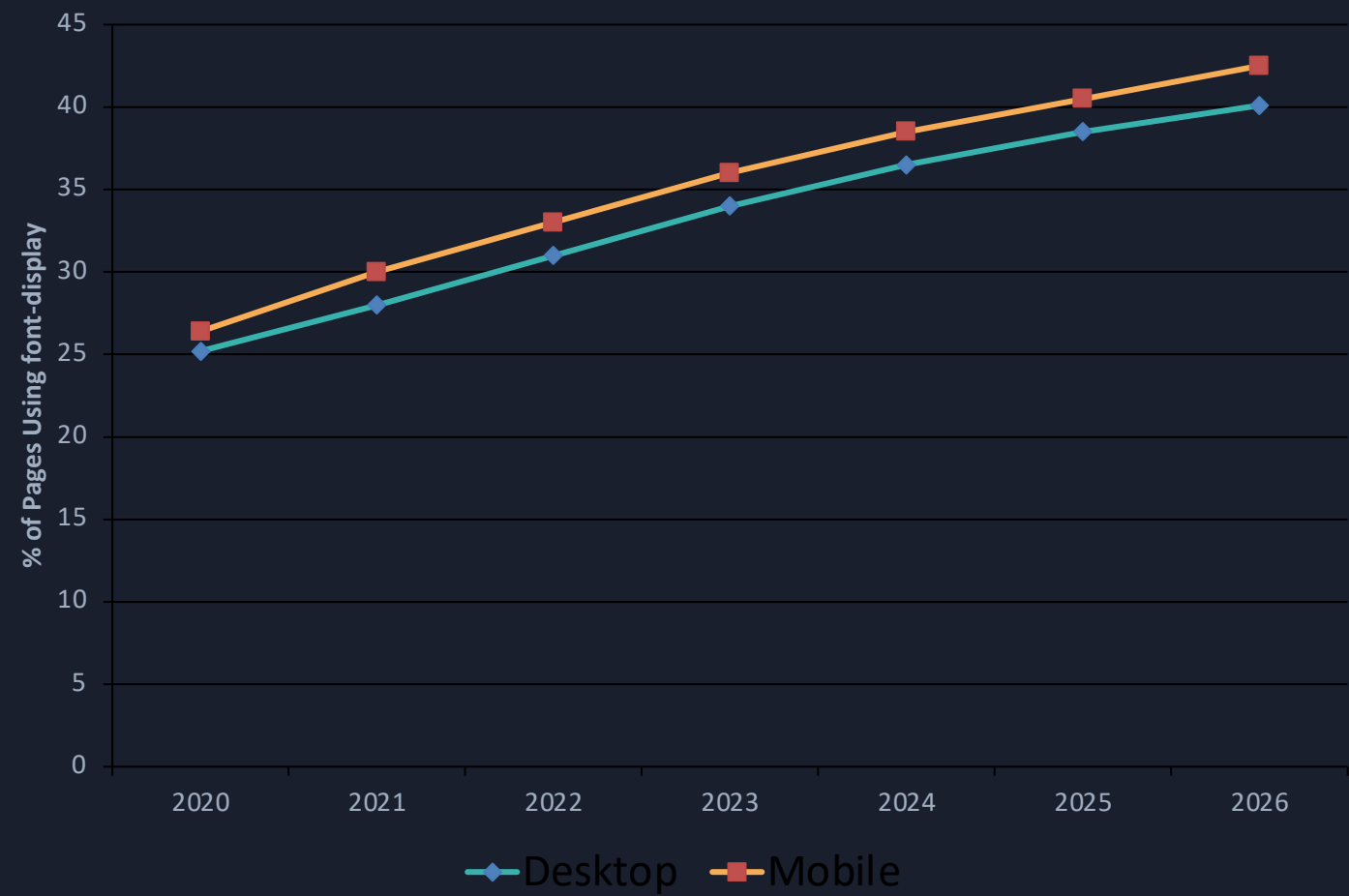
40.0%

Mobile HTTP/3 Support

Growth from near-zero: 38,600% desktop, 5,614% mobile

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

The font-display CSS property avoids Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT). Adoption is rising, yet >50% of pages still risk FOIT.



40.1%
Desktop font-display

42.5%
Mobile font-display

Relative growth since 2020: +14.9% desktop,
+61.0% mobile

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

Five macro trends every performance engineer should benchmark against.

1. Page weight keeps climbing

Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB — roughly 25% heavier than 2020. The 75th percentile exceeds 4,000 KB.

2. HTTPS is the new baseline

At 99.2% desktop / 99.1% mobile, unencrypted HTTP is effectively extinct on the modern web.

3. HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing protocol metric

From near-zero to ~39–40% support in under four years. HTTP/3 is rapidly becoming mainstream.

4. Fewer TCP connections despite more requests

Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 cut median connections per page by 14–27%, improving network efficiency.

Call to Action: Benchmark your own sites against these baselines and prioritize the gaps.

At ~40–42% adoption, most pages still risk FOIT. Significant room for improvement in font-loading LIX.